

Ashu Arora

✉ aashuzarora@gmail.com ☎ +91-88588-696-24 🌐 ashuarora

Education

MA, International Economics and Finance Jul 2023 – May 2024 | Washington D.C., USA
Johns Hopkins School of Advanced International Studies

- Courses & Skills: International Trade, International Finance, Quantitative Global Economics, Development Economics, Econometrics (RCTs, DiD, Fixed Effects, Instrumental Variables, Regression Discontinuity Design), Stata, Data Visualization, Excel for Business & Economics.
- Capstone Project: "Do the Feldstein-Horioka Results Hold Post-COVID?" under Prof. Jaime Marquez, applying panel fixed effects regression and OLS regression for OECD countries (1980-2023) with data extracted and cleaned from IMF WEO, Our World in Data, and the OECD Database using Excel and Stata.
- Extra-Curricular: Staff Writer for The SAIS Observer, MIEF Social Committee Member, SGA Academic Committee Member

MA, Economics Jul 2016 – May 2018 | Prayagraj, India
Ewing Christian College, University of Allahabad

- Courses and Skills: Monetary Economics, Elements of Mathematical Economics and Econometrics, Indian Economy, Statistical Methods and Sampling, Elements of Mathematical Economics and Econometrics
- Dissertation: Does the National Healthcare Program work for the Elderly in India?: A Panel Data Study

BA, Economics & Psychology Jul 2012 – May 2015 | Prayagraj, India
Ewing Christian College, University of Allahabad

- Courses and Skills: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Indian Economy, Social Psychology, Clinical Psychology, Organizational Behaviour.
- Dissertation: Effect of Co-educational Environment on Morality of Youth: A survey study on Undergraduate Students

Work Experience

Limon Bade Rodriguez, Economist, World Bank Jan 2025 – Present
Research Assistant Washington D.C., USA/Remote

- Conducted quantitative impact evaluation of a Global Skill Partnership pilot in the ICT sector (Morocco-Belgium), applying propensity score matching (PSM) to estimate causal effects on employment and job-search outcomes.
- Cleaned, merged, and analyzed participant-level survey and administrative data; constructed treatment and comparison groups, checked covariate balance, and generated robustness diagnostics for evaluation results.
- Produced analytical outputs (tables, figures, and summary statistics) to support research findings, including evidence of increased job search intensity and domestic employment outcomes during the COVID-19 period.

International Student House of Washington DC Aug 2024 – Jul 2025 | Washington D.C., USA
Fellow, Program and Development

- Designed and implemented structured programs like the Ambassador Fellows Program (AFP), including curriculum development and execution strategies, to ensure alignment with I-House DC's mission and best practices in international education and nonprofit management.
- Hosted and organized 50+ events including Ambassador Series, Open House Expo, Alumni Mixing Series and Cultural Events
- Launched Waldo Stevenson (WSF) Forum to actively fe and exchange of ideas among residents closely modeled as the Oxford Union

Johns Hopkins School of Advanced International Studies Sep 2024 – May 2025 | Washington D.C., USA
Teaching Assistant

- Assistant for Econometrics, Economic Development courses; led TA sessions, review classes, and hands-on Stata labs covering data analysis and econometric methods.
- Designed and delivered lecture slides and instructional materials, and provided guidance on group projects, including research design, data handling, and empirical implementation.
- Assisted with exam preparation and grading, evaluated assignments and projects, and offered individualized academic support to students.

Prof. Ritam Chaurey, Johns Hopkins School of Advanced International Studies Jul 2023 – May 2024 | Washington D.C., USA
Graduate Research Assistant

- Critically analyzed civil servant recruitment policies and it's impact on development outcomes using econometric techniques in Stata, taking data from different sources such as LASI, TCPS-IAS, and the RBI Handbook.
- Synthesized 10+ sources to identify research gaps and secured approval for a study launch.
- Produced a research report highlighting the pressing issues related to the development and the method of civil servant recruitment.

Indian Institute of Management, Ahmedabad Jun 2020 – May 2023 | Ahmedabad, India
Teaching and Research Associate (Economics Area)

- Managed and evaluated the participation of 80+ students, conducted weekly doubt-clearing sessions, designed and prepared problem sets and quizzes, and facilitated in-class experiments, contributing to a 10% improvement in student performance.

- Co-authored a research paper "Bleeding at the Margins: Understanding Period Poverty among SC and ST Women", published in the Journal of Development Studies, using the NFHS-5 dataset.
- Conducted research activities like data collection, data cleaning and analysis for Prof. Pritha Dev, Prof. Jeevant Rampal and Prof. Tarun Jain.

Evelyn Learning Systems Private Limited

Aug 2018 – Aug 2019 | New Delhi, India

Economics Curriculum Developer

- Developed case studies and research summaries for government reports and policy papers, supporting applied learning in economics.
- Designed econometrics problem sets and exercises, ensuring methodological accuracy and clarity for students from diverse academic backgrounds.
- Reviewed and refined academic content with a 95% approval rate, and created study materials and quizzes to improve student engagement and learning outcomes.

National Human Rights Commission, India

Dec 2017 – Jan 2018 | New Delhi, India

Intern

- Analyzed health entitlements and service delivery in India, comparing public and private sectors.
- Developed strategic recommendations to expand NHRC's rural outreach, increasing engagement.
- Built a database that helped identify inefficiencies and gaps in healthcare access in India using Excel.

Additional Information

Additional Information

Technical Skills

- Excel, STATA, SPSS, R

Leadership & Academic Engagement

- Staff Writer, The SAIS Observer
- Member, MIEF Social Committee; Student Government Association (SGA) Academic Committee
- Core Member, Social Sciences Club — organized debates, guest lectures, and academic events
- Member, Debating Society

Public Speaking & Outreach

- Regular Speaker, All India Radio, Allahabad (2016–2018)
- Judge, English Creative Writing Competitions at inter-college and school-level events
- Awards & Achievements 4th place (out of 28 teams), Walmart–SAIS Global Policy Challenge
- MIEF Tuition Fee Scholarship (2023) • Abernethy Scholarship (2023–24)
- Graduate Merit Scholarship (2017–18)

Publications

Academic

Babbar, K., Vandana, & Arora, A. (2023). Bleeding at the Margins: Understanding Period Poverty among SC and ST Women Using Decomposition Analysis. The Journal of Development Studies, 1–16. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00220388.2023.2252139>

Non-Academic

Arora, A. (2025, November). Numbers and narratives: The human side of economics research. Anthro Bulletin, 6(11), 8. https://anthroposindiafoundation.com/documents/newsletters/AIF_AnthroBulletin_November2025.pdf Arora, A. (2023, October 25).

Can policy and narratives go hand in hand? The SAIS Observer. <https://saisobserver.org/2023/10/24/can-policy-and-narratives-go-hand-in-hand/>

References

Prof. Ritam Chaurey, Assistant Professor, Johns Hopkins School of Advanced International Studies, Washington DC
rchaurey@jhu.edu, +1 (202) 249-7307

Prof. Jaime Marquez, Senior Lecturer, Johns Hopkins School of Advanced International Studies, Washington DC
jmarque1@jhu.edu, +1 (202) 663-5909

Limon Rodriguez, Economist, World Bank
limonbrodriguez@gmail.com, +65 8308 3348

Karan Babbar, Assistant Professor, Xavier Labour Research Institute
phd17karanb@iima.ac.in, +91-9873655178